Fiscal Impact Statement

Legislative Council Staff

Nonpartisan Services for Colorado's Legislature

AMENDMENT 85: PLAIN LANGUAGE BALLOT QUESTIONS

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Summary Information

Overview. The measure requires ballot questions be written in plain language and at an eighth-grade reading level.

Types of impacts. The measure is projected to affect the following areas:

- Minimal State Workload

Disclaimer. This fiscal impact statement has been prepared for a statewide ballot measure appearing at the 2026 statewide election. Any appropriations required to implement this measure will be addressed through the annual or supplemental budget process if this measure is approved by voters. For more information about this measure, please see the ballot information booklet.

Table 1
State Fiscal Impacts

Type of Impact	Budget Year FY 2025-26	Out Year FY 2026-27
State Revenue	$0	$0
State Expenditures	$0	$0
Transferred Funds	$0	$0
Change in TABOR Refunds	$0	$0
Change in State FTE	0.0 FTE	0.0 FTE

Amendment 85

Summary of Measure

The measure requires that ballot questions, submitted to voters for approval, be written in plain language, at no more than an eighth-grade reading level.

State Expenditures

The measure may minimally increase workload for the Title Board, which includes representatives from the Department of State, the Department of Law, and the state legislature, to determine standards for plain language and what constitutes an eighth-grade reading level.

Effective Date

If approved by voters at the 2026 general election, this measure takes effect upon proclamation of the Governor, no later than 30 days after the official canvass of the vote is completed.

State and Local Government Contacts

Judicial

Secretary of State

Legislative Council Staff